ENGLISH LAB · READING CORNER

Lantern Night

An old lantern. A lost tradition. A secret waiting to be told.



Starter · A1

4 ESO · Seasons & Celebrations · LS2
Six chapters · one a week

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How to read this book

Read one chapter a week at home, with the Learning Path it goes with. Read it once for the story, then again more slowly.

The words in the box at the start help you. They are underlined in the story.

At the end of each chapter, circle one answer to each question. In class we talk about the chapter for ten minutes and see who guessed what happens next.

Llegeix un capítol cada setmana a casa, amb el Learning Path que li toca. Llegeix-lo una vegada per entendre la història i una altra més a poc a poc.

Les paraules del requadre de l'inici t'ajuden: estan subratllades a la història.

Al final de cada capítol, encercla una resposta a cada pregunta. A classe en parlem deu minuts i mirem qui ha endevinat què passa després.

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CHAPTER 1

The lantern in the attic

Read it with Learning Path 0

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

attic = *golfes*
bridge = *pont*
lantern = *fanalet*
witch = *bruixa*

It is the end of October. Núria is fifteen and comes from Catalonia. She is staying with Josh and his family in Ashby, England. Josh is her exchange partner. "Welcome!" Josh says. "Do you like rain?"

"Not every day," says Núria.

It is cold and rainy. Núria gets up at seven, goes to school and has dinner with the family at six. "At home we eat at nine!" she says.

On 31 October Josh's little sister Amy wears a witch costume for Halloween.

Josh has got a pumpkin. Núria talks about the Castanyada. "We eat chestnuts, sweet potatoes and panellets," she says.

"Can we make some?" asks Amy.

"Yes!" Josh's mum says. "There are old trays in the attic."

Josh and Núria go upstairs. The attic is dark. There are boxes and old toys. Under a window Núria sees a red and gold paper lantern. It has got a message: "M. — Lantern Night, at the old bridge. I'll wait for you. T."

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"What's Lantern Night?" Núria asks.

They show it to Gran. She looks at the message. She is not happy. "Please put it back," she says.

Then she leaves the room.

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

What makes Gran upset?

Què preocupa la Gran?

(A) An old lantern with a message

(B) A pumpkin costume

(C) Núria's homework

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What do Josh and Núria find at the library?

Què troben en Josh i la Núria a la biblioteca?

(A) An old phone

(B) A poster for Lantern Night in 1974

(C) A letter from Canada dated today

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CHAPTER 2

A poster from 1974

Read it with Learning Path 1

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

poster = *cartell*
storm = *tempesta*
bridge = *pont*
organiser = *organitzador*

The next day Gran does not come to breakfast. Josh and Núria are worried. "We need to know about Lantern Night," Núria says. They go to the library. Mrs Okafor works there. She knows the history of Ashby.

"Look at this old lantern," Josh says.

"Lantern Night!" Mrs Okafor says. "Come with me."

She shows them a poster from 1974. It says: "LANTERN NIGHT. Saturday 16 November. Parade from the square to the old bridge. Music and food. Bring your lantern!" Mrs Okafor explains that people used to make lanterns at home. Families walked together to the bridge and made a wish. It was a big autumn celebration.

"In Catalonia we celebrate the Castanyada," Núria says. "We eat together."

"And at Diwali there are lights too," says Mrs Okafor.

"Why is there no Lantern Night now?" asks Josh.

"In 1974 there was a terrible storm," she says.

"The bridge closed. The organiser moved to Canada. His name was Tom Barker." Núria looks at the message on the lantern.

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"T is for Tom!" she says.

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

What did people do at Lantern Night?

Què feia la gent a Lantern Night?

- (A) They held a parade to the old bridge
- (B) They went on a school trip to London
- (C) They played a football match

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

Who is M on the lantern?

Qui és M al fanalet?

- (A) Mrs Okafor
- (B) Amy
- (C) Gran, whose name was Margaret Hall

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CHAPTER 3

Who is M?

Read it with Learning Paths 2 and 3

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

trust = *confiar*
married = *casada*
newspaper = *diari*
bring back = *recuperar*

Josh and Núria are at the kitchen table with a laptop. They want to know more about Tom Barker and M. First, they find a website with no name and no date. It says two families had a fight.

"We can't trust this," Núria says.

Next, they see an old photo with no information.

"Who took it?" asks Josh.

Then they find the Ashby Herald, a newspaper. The article has a date: 17 November 1974. It says the storm closed the bridge.

Tom Barker went to Canada. There is also a photo. A young woman is holding a red and gold lantern. Her name is Margaret Hall.

"Margaret is Gran's name!" Josh says. "Hall was her name before she got married."

"So M is Gran!" says Núria.

Josh looks sad.

"Tom waited for her at the bridge. But the bridge was closed." Núria thinks about the festival.

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"We can bring Lantern Night back," she says. "This year?"

"Yes! We can make lanterns. We can invite people. Your school can help!"

Josh smiles. "Then we need a plan."

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

Which source gives the most reliable evidence?

Quina font ofereix les proves més fiables?

- (A) An anonymous forum
- (B) A dated newspaper article with a journalist's name
- (C) A photo without a date

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What permission will the group need?

Quin permís necessitarà el grup?

- (A) Permission to use the old bridge
- (B) Permission to travel to Canada
- (C) Permission to change schools

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CHAPTER 4

Plan the day

Read it with Learning Path 4

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

timetable = *horari*
permission = *permís*
workshop = *taller*
council = *ajuntament*

On Monday Josh and Núria meet their friends Priya and Callum at school. "We can bring Lantern Night back!" Núria says. "It's on Saturday 12 December."

"I can make posters," Callum says.

"I can make a timetable," Priya says. They make a plan: a lantern workshop at school, food in the square and music at the bridge.

"The workshop starts at four," says Josh. "The parade leaves at six."

"What about the weather?" Callum asks.

"Bring an umbrella!" Núria says.

They talk to Mr Davies, the head teacher. He says they can use the school hall. Priya asks her uncle's band to play. Callum makes a poster.

"We need permission for the old bridge," Josh says. "The council looks after it."

"I'll write an email," says Núria. "We would like to use the bridge for our celebration."

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That evening Josh puts Callum's poster on the kitchen table. It says: "ASHBY LANTERN NIGHT IS BACK!" Gran reads the poster. She looks at Josh and Núria. "Who told you about Tom?" she asks.

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

What must they ask the council?

Què han de demanar a l'ajuntament?

- (A) Money for fireworks
- (B) A new bus
- (C) Permission to use the bridge

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What will Gran do after seeing the poster?

Què farà la Gran després de veure el cartell?

- (A) Tell the teenagers her story
- (B) Leave Ashby forever
- (C) Stop the school project immediately

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CHAPTER 5

Gran's story

Read it with Learning Path 5

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

council = *ajuntament*
grandad = *avi*
bridge = *pont*
formal email = *correu formal*

The family is quiet. Gran sits down and tells them her story. "Tom lived next door," she says. "We were friends. We used to organise Lantern Night together. Then we loved each other."

Tom got a job in Canada. He wanted Gran to come with him. He wrote a message on her lantern. He waited for her at the bridge on Lantern Night.

"But there was a storm," Gran says. "My father didn't let me go out. The bridge closed. Tom went to Canada the next week."

"That's very sad," says Josh.

"I had a happy life with your grandad," Gran says.

"But I remember the festival." That evening Núria writes a formal email to the council. "Dear Councillor Hughes, We would like to organise Lantern Night on Saturday 12 December. Could we use the old bridge from six to eight? Kind regards, Núria Puig."

She sends it. In his room Josh searches online for Tom Barker. He finds an older man in Canada.

There is a red and gold lantern in his photo. Josh writes a message: "Hello. I think you knew my gran, Margaret Hall…"

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THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

Why did Margaret miss Tom at the bridge?

Per què la Margaret no es va trobar amb en Tom al pont?

- (A) She forgot the date
- (B) The storm and her father kept her home, and the bridge closed
- (C) Tom went to a different town

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What will Tom do after Josh contacts him?

Què farà en Tom després del missatge d'en Josh?

- (A) Delete the message
- (B) Send a photo of Australia
- (C) Come to Lantern Night

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CHAPTER 6

Lantern Night

Read it with the final product

WORDS TO HELP YOU · PARAULES QUE T'AJUDEN

council = *ajuntament*
bridge = *pont*
foggy = *emboirat*
newspaper = *diari*

Two answers arrive. The council says yes: the group can use the old bridge. Tom Barker also answers Josh, but Josh keeps the message a secret. It is Saturday 12 December. In the morning it is foggy and cold. In the afternoon the sky is clear. At four o'clock families come to the school hall.

They make colourful lanterns. There is music and food. Núria brings panellets. At six the parade starts. People walk from the square to the old bridge.

Gran carries her old red and gold lantern. Josh walks with her. On the other side of the bridge there is an older man. He has got a red and gold lantern too. "Hello, Margaret," he says. "Sorry I'm late."

"Tom!" Gran says.

"Only fifty-two years late!" Everybody laughs.

Gran and Tom are happy to see each other. The next morning the newspaper says Lantern Night is back. It is going to be celebrated next December too.

"Are you coming back?" Josh asks Núria.

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"Of course," she says. "And I'm bringing panellets!"

THINK ABOUT IT

Circle one answer for each question. · Encercla una resposta a cada pregunta.

1 · DID YOU UNDERSTAND? · HO HAS ENTÈS?

Who appears at the old bridge?

Qui apareix al pont vell?

- (A) Tom Barker with a lantern
- (B) A television presenter
- (C) The mayor in a witch costume

2 · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT? GUESS! · QUÈ PASSARÀ? ENDEVINA-HO!

What does the town plan to do next December?

Què preveu fer el poble el desembre següent?

- (A) Close the bridge again
- (B) Celebrate Lantern Night again
- (C) Cancel all winter festivals

✦ ✦ ✦

The end

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